

Chapter 11

The Decision Is Up to You

Ten thousand millionaires. We talked to 10,000 millionaires about what wealth really looks like in America today, and you may have been surprised by what we found. We saw that there are more millionaires in the country today than ever before—almost eleven million of them.³⁵ We learned who they are, how they act, and how they built wealth. We saw what their lives looked like before, during, and after their wealth building. We've seen where they came from—and where their *wealth* came from. We didn't just look at the stats; we got to know these people. We examined story after story of America's millionaires. And, like I told you early in the book, most of these stories are a little boring. These men and women didn't have crazy, bold, unusual, world-changing careers. They're teachers and accountants. Military personnel and mid-level management. Engineers and farmers. Remember, only 15% of millionaires held senior leadership positions in their careers; the rest—a whopping 85%—were regular people working regular jobs. And now they're millionaires.

In the first part of the book, we debunked three myth categories about the typical millionaire. We saw that what most people assume about millionaires is just plain wrong—nothing more than prejudice, lies, and excuses. First, we tore apart the myth that wealthy people didn't earn or deserve their wealth. There were no enormous inheritances or luck